

3.1 Content, Design, And The Title

Like most of what we'll be talking about here, the title, and the design reflecting the content, are important considerations. You'll realise the importance of making the content go with the design when you see a blog that doesn't follow the rule. You don't want to have a hate blog with flowers in the background, do you? No, jokes apart, if you're going to be blogging about your dreams and such, flowers will grace the background well. If you're writing about something serious—say science and technology—keep the design spartan, with possibly a picture or two that indicate(s) what your blog is about. As an aside, we've seen Web pages about Web design that aren't well-designed themselves!

The colour of the background, the background image(s), the font(s), the placement of items—all go into the making of a good blog. As a corollary, you should decide on what you're going to write about before you go about designing it.

As for what you should put on your page besides text, use common sense. Just one example: if your blog is light-hearted, you *might* want to include such things as “my current mood”; if you're very young, it's perfectly fine to animate the emoticon as well, on a MySpace blog, for example. Now if you're 45 and are blogging about politics, the “current mood” thing is, we think, a rather bad idea!

Another aside: a balance you should strive to strike. You need to determine who your readers will be, and blog for them. At the same time, you've got to let your identity come through. It's up to you how you'll achieve that balance—the sweet spot.

Coming to the title, we should mention that it's in general not a good idea to use a grandiose title for your blog, such as “The World According To Me.” No-one likes narcissistic titles... or a clichéd one like “Life, The Universe, And Everything,” or any of its variants. “My blog” or “(your name)'s blog” is also boring. Either